2 Digital literacy: Explorers



You will learn

- how to use technology to send and receive messages
- to describe the parts of a message
- how to respond to a communication you are not sure about, or find worrying.

People are curious. For thousands of years, people have been curious to find new places, far away from their homes.

In this unit you are going to pretend to be explorers. An explorer travels to new places. An explorer might learn about plants, animals and the environment. An explorer might search for treasure or a place to build a home.



Talk about...

We communicate with each other in lots of different ways. How many different ways of communicating can you think of?



Learning outcomes: Use technology to send and receive messages; Describe the parts of a message; Explain how to respond to an unsuitable communication



email
spam phishing attachment
inbox email address
domain pharming



Class activity

Work in a group. Draw and write to show the journey of an explorer. Show some of the places they went and what they did. If you know about a real explorer from your country you can use them as an example. Or you can use an imaginary example, such as the first person to go to Mars.

Did you know?

Ibn Battuta was a famous explorer from Morocco. He lived more than 600 years ago. Ibn Battuta travelled over Africa, the Middle East and much of Asia.





2.1 Communicating

In this lesson

You will learn:

- about different ways of communicating
- what email is.

Spiral back

Last year you learned how to use the internet to find information. You learned how to say what kinds of information are personal and private, and how to stay safe and happy in the computer room. In this unit you are going to learn how to use the internet to send and receive messages.

Ways of communicating

We can communicate in lots of different ways. To communicate means to share ideas or information with another person.



Some letters are personal. Some letters are about practical things.

Sometimes we need to send a message very quickly. We can use electronic mail, called **email**, to send messages immediately. Email uses the internet to send the message.

Some ways of communicating are very reliable. 'Reliable' means that the message will definitely get to the other person.

Some ways of communicating are private. They will only be seen by one person.

Some ways of communicating are very quick.

Some ways of communicating are easy to use.

Activity

Look at these ways of communicating.

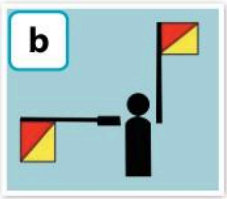
Which way or ways are reliable?

Which way or ways are private?

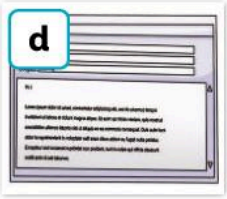
Which way or ways are quick?

Which way or ways are easy to use?

















Extra challenge

Can you make up your own way of communicating?

Think again

Email is very popular. Why do you think email is so popular?

Digital citizen of the future

Some email systems seem to be free to use. You do not have to pay for a stamp to send the email.

We call the companies who make email systems 'email providers'. How do you think email providers make money?

2.2 What does an email look like?

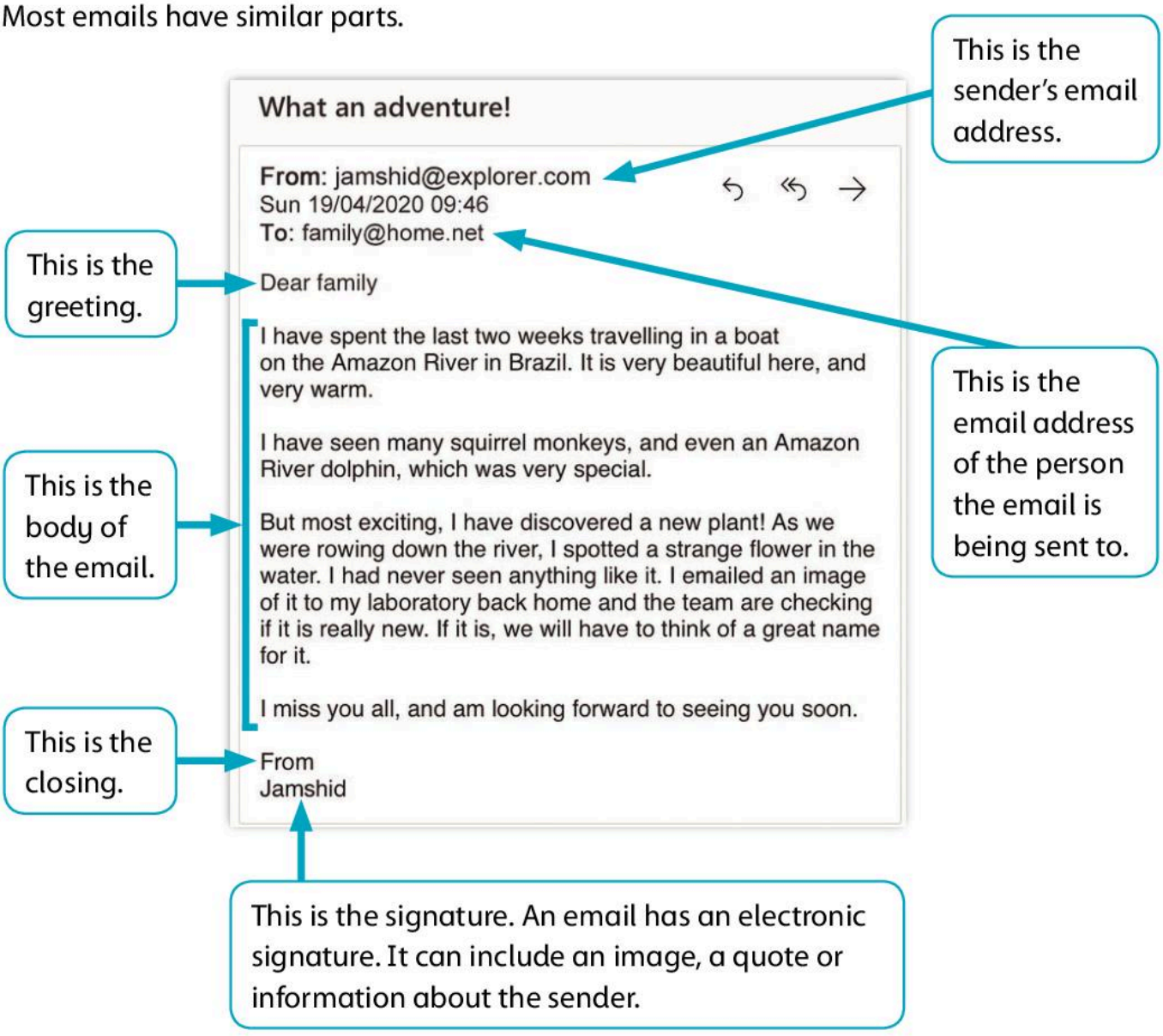
In this lesson

You will learn:

- about the different parts of an email.

Parts of an email

Most emails have similar parts.



Activity

You are going to open your own email account.

Follow the instructions from your teacher for the type of email system your school uses.

Open a new email.

Can you find the right places to put the:

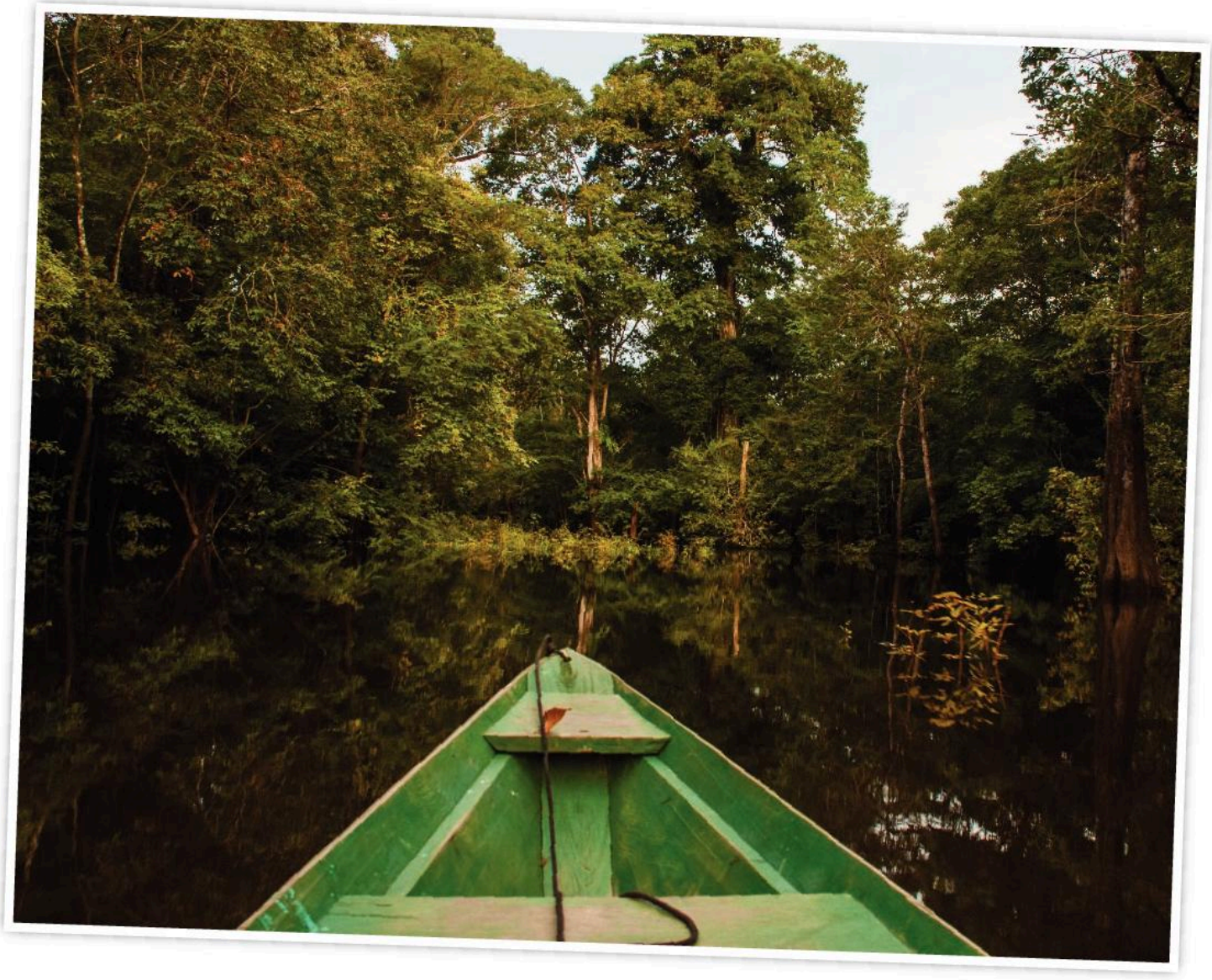
- email address you are sending to
- subject
- body
- signature?

Extra challenge

What is the best way to send different messages? Talk with a classmate about different kinds of messages and the best ways to send them. For example, phone, talking face-to-face or a letter.

Think again

Where should you click to send the email? Draw or write your answer.



2.3 Send an email

In this lesson

You will learn:

- how to send an email.

Email address

The **email address** tells the computer which email box the message needs to go to.

Look at Ynes' email address. What do you notice? It has three parts.

1 This is the local-part. The local-part can be something like a name, or something that does not say who you are.

3 This is the **domain**. The domain can be a place like a school or business. The domain can be an email provider.

ynesmexia@botanistexplorer.com

2 @ means 'at'

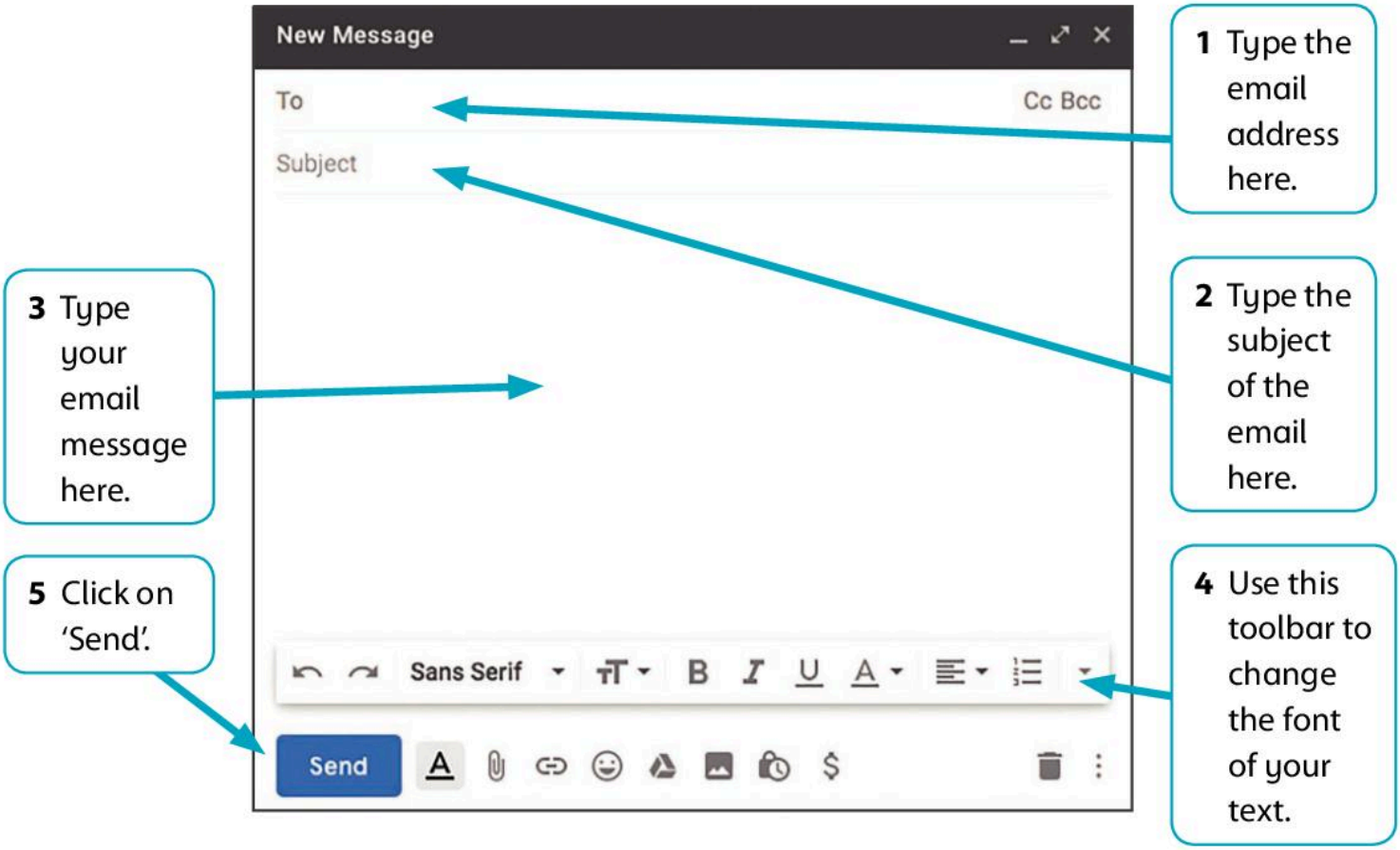
All email addresses have these three parts.

Emails can be sent in two ways. Emails can be sent from an email client. An email client is software on a computer. Emails can also be sent through web-based email clients. This means emails can be sent from anywhere with an internet connection.

Sending an email

Start a new email. Different email providers do this in different ways. Click on 'Compose', 'New' or 'New Message'.





Activity

Imagine you are an explorer travelling in a desert.

Write an email to your teacher about what the desert is like.

Use the internet to find out about hot and cold deserts if you need more information.

Extra challenge

Find out the email address of someone in your class. Send them an email about a country you would like to visit one day.

Explore more

Use the internet to find out about an explorer. This picture shows the explorer and botanist Ynes Mexia.



2.4 Open an email

In this lesson

You will learn:

➔ how to open an email.

How to open an email

You will find new emails in your **inbox**. Your inbox is an electronic folder in your email where your new emails arrive.

A new email is often shown in bold.

Click on the bold text to open the email.

☐ ☆ **me** **A new camp** We arrived in Drake Passage last night. The penguins were **11:16am**



How to reply to an email

To reply to an email, click on the word 'Reply', or the 'Reply' icon.



Type your email and click on 'Send'.





Activity

Last lesson, for 'Explore more' you found out some facts about an explorer. Think of one fact. Write your fact as a sentence.

Send an email to a classmate with the fact.

Open and read the email a classmate sends you.



Extra challenge

A classmate has sent you an email. Reply to the email. Tell the sender what you found interesting about the fact.

Think again

Why could it be useful to have a copy of the emails you send?



2.5 Attachments

In this lesson

You will learn:

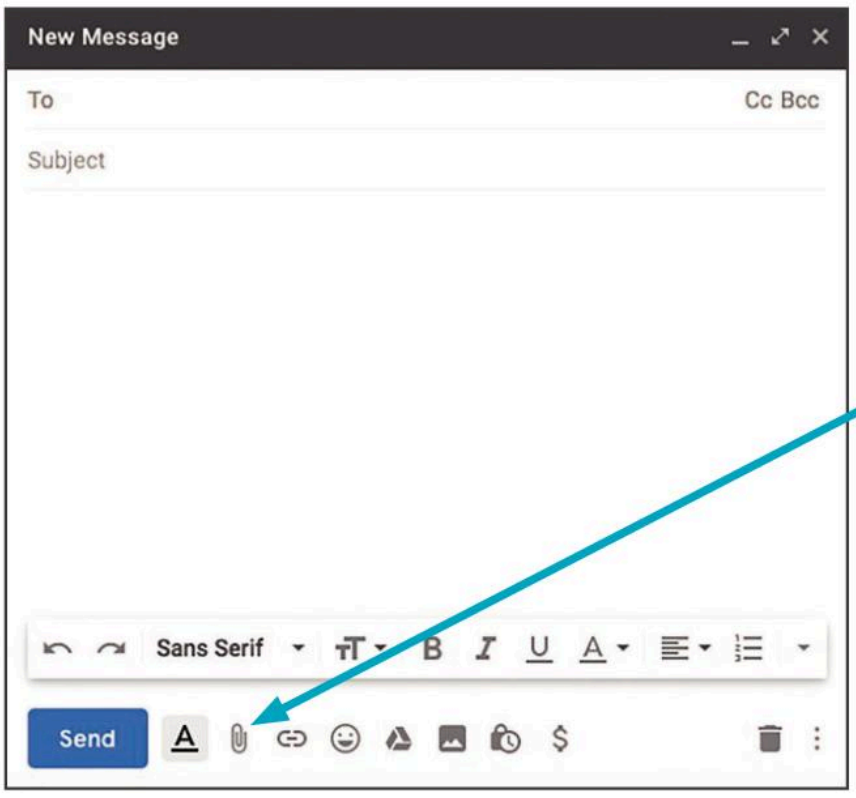
- what an attachment is
- how to send an attachment.

What is an attachment?

The word 'attach' means to join onto something else. An **attachment** is an extra file that you can send with an email. The attachment is joined onto the email.

An attachment can be a:

- photograph
- document
- sound file
- video.



Click the 'paperclip' symbol. The symbol means 'attachment'. A box will open. Choose the file you want to attach. Double-click on the file you want, or click on 'Attach' or 'Open'.

Activity

Imagine you are a mountain explorer.

Find an image of a mountain on the internet that is free to use.

Save the image.

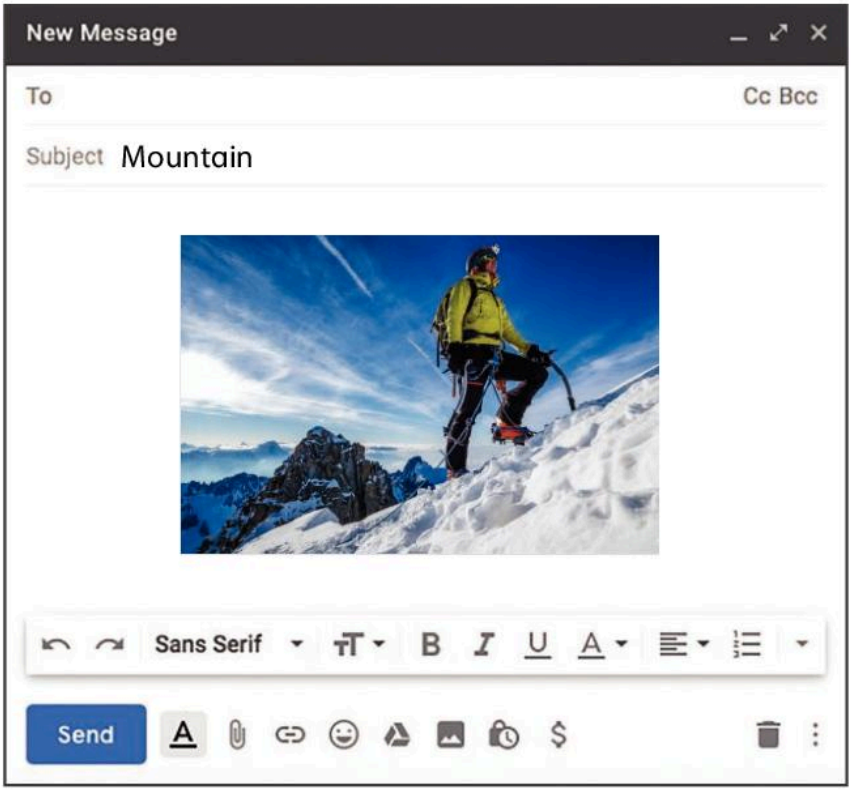
Open a new email.

Type 'Mountain' in the subject.

Type one sentence about the image you have chosen.

Attach the image.

Send the email to a classmate.

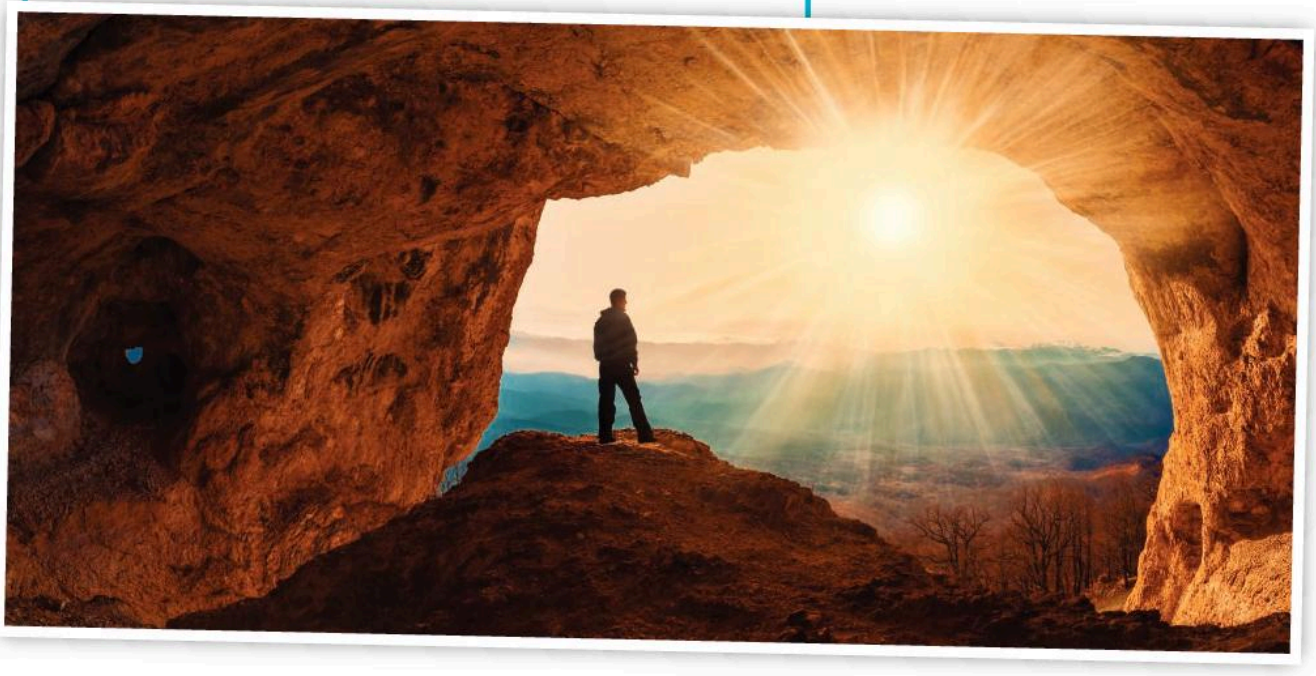


Extra challenge

Open the email you received from a classmate. Double-click on the attachment to open it. Describe the picture in one sentence.

Think again

Say one thing you can attach to an email as well as a picture.



2.6 Staying safe

In this lesson

You will learn:

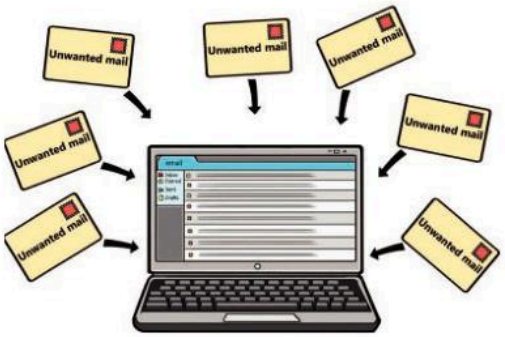
- what spam, phishing and pharming are
- how to stay safe when you use email.

Spam, phishing and pharming

Most people use email to communicate with other people.

Sadly, some people use email to do things that harm other people.

Spam email tries to sell you something when you have not asked for it. Spammers send thousands of emails.



Phishing means sending an email with an address that is not real. The phishing email is trying to get personal and private information from you.

Pharming emails send you to a fake website. The website asks for your personal and private information.





Stay safe

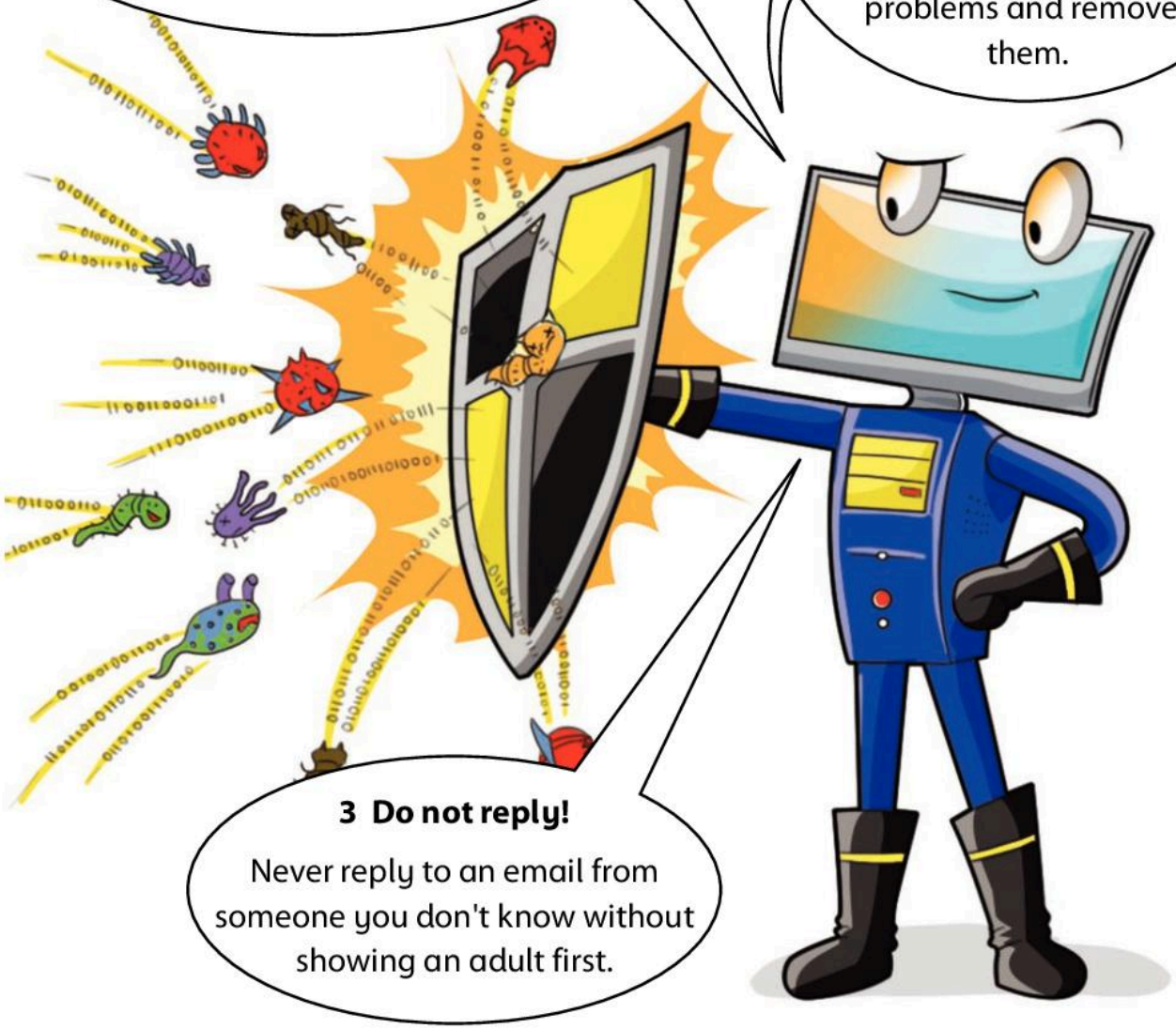
Protect yourself with the three email safety rules.

1 Keep it closed!

Never open emails that look a bit strange, or have a strange subject. If you do not recognise the sender, do not open the email. Show it to an adult you trust.

2 Protect!

Make sure your computer has good virus protection. This is software that prevents problems on your computer. It also finds problems and removes them.



3 Do not reply!

Never reply to an email from someone you don't know without showing an adult first.

Activity

Make a poster for your classroom with the three email safety rules.

Extra challenge

Send an email to your teacher saying what pharming and phishing are.

Check what you know

You have learned

- how to use technology to send and receive messages
- to describe the parts of a message
- how to respond to a communication you are not sure about, or find worrying.

Test

Deep-sea creatures

From: jack@deepsea.com
Mon 13/01/2020 14:02
To: maya@home.com



Dear Sister

We went on a deep-sea dive today, into a trench no one has explored before.

I saw a beautiful angler fish. I have attached a photograph of the fish.

Love
Your brother

1. What is this email about?
2. Who sent this email?
3. What date did they send it?
4. This is a friendly email. What would you do if you received an email you were unsure or worried about?
5. What is the name of the file attached to this email?
6. Describe one risk from opening this file attachment.

Activities

Your teacher has sent you an email.

1 Open and read the email. Write down what it is about.

2 Write a reply to the email.

3 If you can, add a suitable attachment.

4 Send the email reply to your teacher.

Self-evaluation

- I know how to stay safe when I use email.
- I answered test question 1.
- I completed activity 1.
- I have opened and sent an email in class.
- I answered test questions 1–4.
- I completed activities 1 and 2 and sent the email.
- I have attached an image to an email and sent the email in class.
- I answered all the test questions.
- I completed all the activities.

Re-read any parts of the unit you feel unsure about. Try the test and activities again – can you do more this time?

